



Incident report analysis

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this chart as a way to practice applying the NIST framework to different situations you encounter.

Summary	The organization experienced a Denial-of-Service (DoS) attack in which a malicious actor flooded the company’s network with a large number of ICMP ping packets. The attack was possible because the organization had an unconfigured firewall that did not properly restrict incoming ICMP traffic. As a result, the network became overwhelmed, and employees were unable to access normal network resources for approximately two hours. The incident response team contained the attack by blocking incoming ICMP traffic, taking non-critical network services offline, and restoring critical services. After investigating the incident, the security team improved the network’s defenses by adding ICMP rate limiting, source IP verification, network monitoring, and IDS/IPS protections. These measures are intended to detect abnormal traffic and prevent similar attacks from significantly disrupting network availability in the future.
Identify	The organization experienced a security event when its network services suddenly stopped responding for approximately two hours. The cybersecurity team determined that the disruption was caused by a Denial-of-Service (DoS) attack involving a flood of incoming ICMP packets. The attack entered through

	an unconfigured firewall and overwhelmed the network, preventing normal internal traffic from accessing network resources. The incident management team responded by blocking incoming ICMP packets, stopping non-critical network services, and restoring critical services.
Protect	The cybersecurity team should configure and regularly review firewall rules to limit unnecessary incoming ICMP traffic. The team implemented an ICMP rate-limiting rule and an IDS/IPS system to filter suspicious ICMP traffic. Source IP verification should also be used to prevent spoofed addresses from entering the network. Regular firewall configuration reviews and security assessments should be performed to prevent similar vulnerabilities.
Detect	The cybersecurity team should continuously monitor network traffic for unusual activity, including large amounts of incoming ICMP traffic from external or non-trusted IP addresses. Network monitoring software should be used to detect abnormal traffic patterns, while the IDS/IPS can identify and filter suspicious traffic. Firewall and network logs should also be regularly reviewed to identify unusual traffic, repeated connection attempts, or other signs of an attack.
Respond	For future security events, the cybersecurity team should quickly identify and contain the affected network systems by blocking malicious ICMP traffic at the firewall. Non-critical network services can be temporarily stopped to reduce network traffic and protect critical services. The team should then analyze firewall, IDS/IPS, and network monitoring logs to determine the source and impact of the incident. All incidents should be documented and reported to management, and the response plan should be updated based on lessons learned.
Recover	To recover from a future ICMP flood attack, the organization should first block or limit the malicious traffic at the firewall. The team should verify that the network is secure and restore critical network services first. Once the network

	is stable and the attack has ended, non-critical services can be brought back online. Network activity should continue to be monitored after recovery to make sure the attacker does not resume the attack. The organization should also review and update its firewall and incident response procedures to reduce the impact of future attacks.
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Reflections/Notes:
